

10. Flip Scenario

During an academic session, an instructor notices a student repeatedly looking down at their phone under the desk. The student is not being disruptive but is clearly not fully engaged in the lesson.

When the instructor asks the student to put the phone away, the student responds, “I’m just checking a message from my parent—it’s important.” The student briefly puts the phone away but continues to check it intermittently throughout the class.

Later, the instructor notices that several other students have also started quietly using their phones during the session. The instructor appears frustrated but does not address it again.

After class, the instructor comes to your office and mentions that this behavior has been happening more frequently and is starting to impact the learning environment.

- Do you see any issue with this situation? Why or why not?
- At what point does this become a problem?